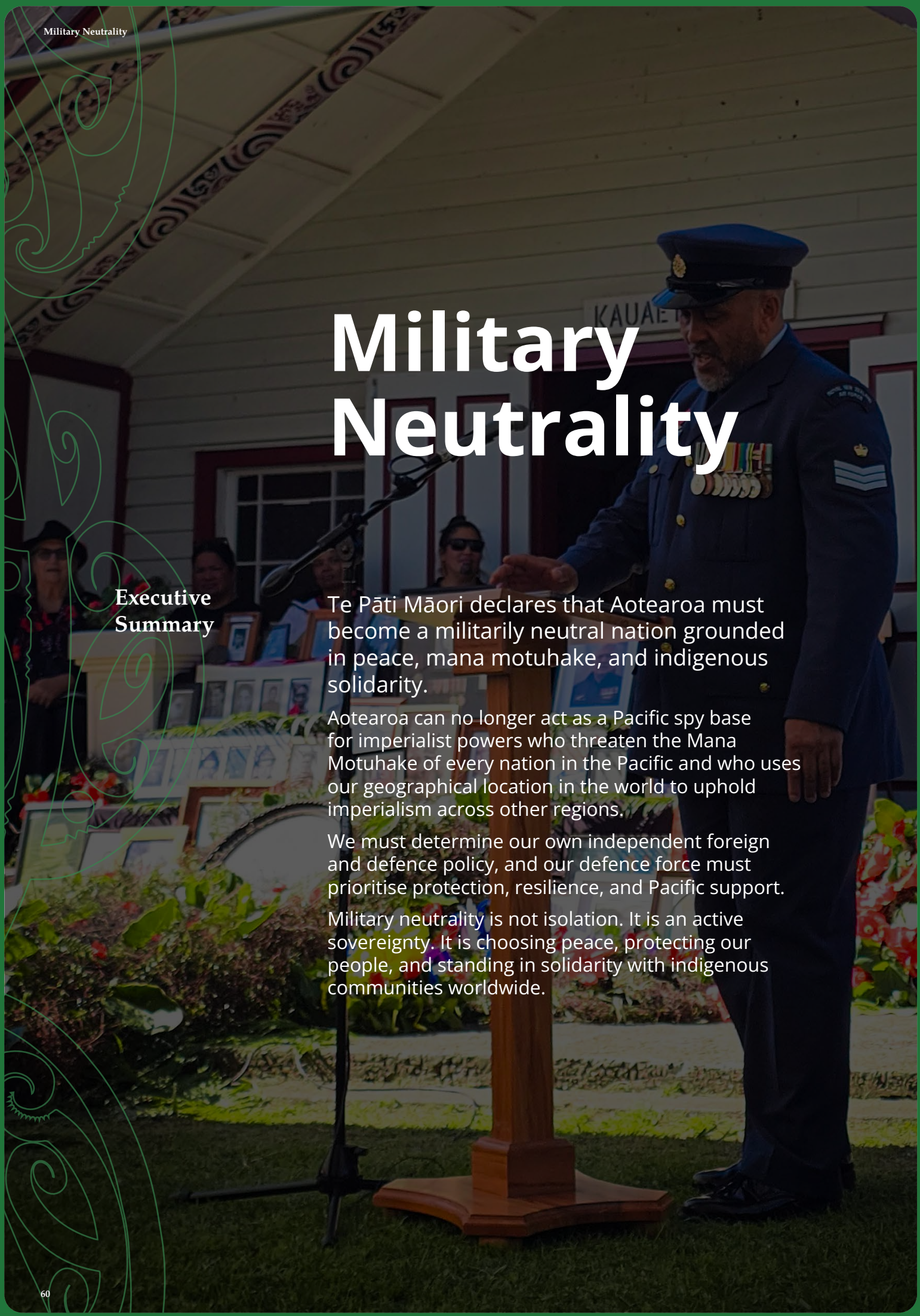


Military Neutrality

Executive Summary

Te Pāti Māori declares that Aotearoa must become a militarily neutral nation grounded in peace, mana motuhake, and indigenous solidarity.

Aotearoa can no longer act as a Pacific spy base for imperialist powers who threaten the Mana Motuhake of every nation in the Pacific and who uses our geographical location in the world to uphold imperialism across other regions.

We must determine our own independent foreign and defence policy, and our defence force must prioritise protection, resilience, and Pacific support.

Military neutrality is not isolation. It is an active sovereignty. It is choosing peace, protecting our people, and standing in solidarity with indigenous communities worldwide.

Context

For generations, Māori have been called to fight in wars that were not our own.

From the Pioneer Battalion to the Māori Battalion, and through conflicts in Korea, Malaya, Vietnam and Afghanistan, Māori service has been marked by sacrifice. Yet, on return, our people were met with no land allocations, no housing support, and no enduring benefit for our communities.

This reflects a broader truth: participation in imperial wars has not advanced the wellbeing or sovereignty of Māori.

Our foreign affairs and defence policies have been shaped externally through alliances driven by global powers. This undermines our ability to act in accordance with our own values as tangata whenua.

We must also remember that colonisation is a global empire. Our Mana Motuhake is inherently tied to the liberation of all indigenous peoples across the world.

The changing global environment demands a reset toward peace, diplomacy, and indigenous solidarity.

Our Position

We must work to achieve a demilitarised Pacific, free from the influence of foreign militaries and their destructive legacies.

Our sovereignty cannot be dictated by foreign powers. We reject involvement in conflicts with other indigenous peoples on their own lands and oppose Aotearoa being used as a base for foreign military intelligence alliances.

While we advance a policy of military neutrality, we understand that lasting peace cannot be achieved without justice. We are committed to upholding international human rights and holding war criminals to account.

Military neutrality is an expression of mana motuhake in action.

Te Pāti Māori will...

1. Declare Aotearoa a Militarily Neutral Nation

- Legislate neutrality and prohibit participation in foreign wars unless directly threatened.

2. Reset Foreign Policy

- Develop an independent foreign policy grounded in Māori values and prioritise Pacific and indigenous relationships.

3. Withdraw from Compromising Military Alignments

- Review and withdraw from arrangements that undermine sovereignty.

4. Transform the Role of the Defence Force

- Refocus on protection, disaster response, and Pacific support.

5. Embed Indigenous Values

- Ensure decisions reflect manaakitanga, whanaungatanga, and rangatiratanga.

6. Promote Global Peace Leadership

- Position Aotearoa as a neutral mediator and advocate for indigenous rights.

7. Uphold International Human Rights

- Sanction nations involved in illegal wars and cut diplomatic relations with government's actively committing war crimes.

Our Commitment

Te Pāti Māori is committed to asserting tino rangatiratanga over foreign and defence policy, protecting our people, and leading with peace.

We will not trade our mana for alliances that struggle to recognise that mana in the first place.